

Subject Line: Biofarm: February Stories from the Ground

## A clear view on BNG, land and long-term value

Two years after becoming statutory in England, Biodiversity Net Gain (BNG) is no longer an emerging policy. It is now a material factor in development viability and land management decisions.

This month, we share what BNG has delivered so far, where the market is heading next, and how developers and landowners can position themselves to create value as demand continues to grow.

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## Beyond policy: BNG two years on



Two years after becoming statutory, BNG has moved from policy intent to a functioning nature market. It is reshaping how development and land management work together, directing private investment into nature recovery while helping unlock housing, infrastructure and regeneration.

Off-site BNG has been a critical enabler, allowing schemes to move forward where on-site constraints would otherwise delay or prevent development, while delivering measurable gains for nature.

The pace of growth has been significant. Over the past year, the Biodiversity Gain Site Register has grown from 40 to 188 sites, signalling increasing confidence from landowners, developers and investors alike. While government reporting to date captures only limited statutory credit transactions, industry analysis indicates that private capital committed to off-site habitat creation and long-term management is substantial, with estimates running into the hundreds of millions of pounds.

This growth has not been without challenge. The market has faced scrutiny, consultation and speculation around legislative change and has emerged more resilient as a result.

Capability across the system continues to improve. Local planning authorities are becoming more consistent, specialist ecological expertise is deepening, and collaboration between landowners, developers, consultants and planners is strengthening market confidence and integrity.

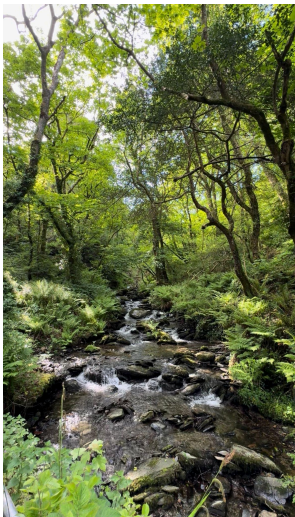
Looking ahead, policy evolution will play a key role in shaping how BNG is delivered alongside development. Clearer frameworks and delivery mechanisms are expected to support compliance with BNG requirements while enabling development to proceed, helping to reduce uncertainty across the planning system. In parallel, advances in data availability and environmental technology are likely to improve the transparency and measurability of BNG outcomes, strengthening monitoring, accountability and confidence in the market.

Two years in, BNG is becoming a defining feature of land use and development in England. Those who plan early, understand local demand and invest in high-quality habitats will be best placed as the market continues to mature.

[CTA] Invest in high-quality off-site BNG

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## Beyond availability: bringing forward local BNG when it's needed



Biofarm has partnered with [Onyx](#), a UK commercial property developer focused on delivering flexible, sustainable business parks for growing enterprises, to provide a locally aligned BNG solution for a new commercial scheme at Tolvaddon Business Park in Cornwall.

The development will deliver 30 new commercial units, creating adaptable workspace for local businesses and supporting employment and economic activity in the area. Planning consent required a local BNG offset, but at the time no locally registered habitat units were available.

By engaging Biofarm early, Onyx was able to move quickly and with confidence. We worked closely with their team to establish a clear delivery programme, enter into a conservation covenant and bring forward the registration of [Biofarm's Lesnewth habitat bank](#) (NCA 154, 153, 157, 155, 156, 152, 149) in Cornwall.

Working collaboratively with Cornwall Council, we supported Onyx through the planning process and achieved full registration of Lesnewth within the timeframe committed. This enabled the project to discharge its pre-commencement condition and proceed without delay.

Beyond unlocking development, the Lesnewth habitat bank is now enabling substantive ecological work on the ground. The fully registered site (BGS-221025001) spans a mosaic of habitat types - including grassland, heathland and scrub - that are key to supporting local biodiversity and broader landscape connectivity. These habitats will be carefully managed to protect and restore elements of Cornwall's natural heritage, enhancing conditions for a range of species and strengthening ecosystem resilience in a region where ancient and irreplaceable habitats have been under pressure.

This intentional ecological investment not only delivers against BNG obligations but contributes to long-term nature recovery within the local National Character Areas, ensuring that development supports, rather than simply offsets, broader environmental priorities.

The project demonstrates how early engagement and well-planned BNG delivery can remove uncertainty, unlock development and investment in both nature and the local economy.

[CTA] Speak to us early about bespoke, deliverable, local BNG solutions

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## Beyond constraint: enabling aviation infrastructure through BNG innovation



Biofarm recently delivered a BNG solution supporting temporary operational requirements at [BAE Systems](#) aviation site in Rochester.

The development affected a nationally important open mosaic habitat and required a solution that worked for both nature and operational continuity. Biofarm designed a bespoke approach combining long-term off-site biodiversity delivery with on-site habitat reinstatement at the end of the four-year term.

The result: the development could proceed, BNG liability was significantly reduced, and robust biodiversity outcomes were secured.

This project demonstrates how BNG can enable development rather than constrain it, aligning ecological delivery with real-world operational needs and directing investment where it delivers the greatest benefit.

[CTA] For high-integrity, cost-effective BNG, get in touch

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## Beyond production: working with nature to strengthen food security



Food security depends on more than farms, yields and supply chains. It depends on healthy land.

Soil, water and biodiversity form the foundation of food production, and when ecosystems decline, farming becomes more exposed to disruption. Recent [government assessments](#) have highlighted how biodiversity loss and environmental degradation are now recognised as risks to food and water security, with implications for long-term stability.

There is also reason for optimism. Across the UK, farmers are increasingly adopting regenerative approaches that rebuild soil health, enhance biodiversity and reduce exposure to shocks. These approaches were a major focus at the [2026 Oxford Real Farming Conference](#), where practical, nature-led solutions were shown to be taking root on the ground. These practices are proving that productivity and nature recovery can go hand in hand.

BNG is becoming an increasingly important tool in this transition. By supporting the creation and long-term management of habitats alongside working farmland, BNG helps improve soil structure, water retention and ecosystem function across the wider landscape. Healthier soils and more diverse habitats support pollination, natural pest control and water regulation – all critical to stable food production.

For landowners, BNG can also provide a reliable income stream that helps offset the short-term costs of transitioning away from more intensive practices. By reducing financial risk, it gives farmers the confidence to invest in soil health and nature-positive management while maintaining long-term economic resilience.

The benefits extend beyond the farm gate. Restored habitats slow runoff, healthier soils absorb and hold more water, and well-managed landscapes reduce flood risk – protecting productive land, stabilising yields and reducing disruption to food supply chains as extreme weather becomes more frequent.

By working with nature, through regenerative farming supported by BNG, we can build landscapes that are both productive and resilient, strengthening food security while restoring the natural systems it depends on.

Where risk is recognised, action is growing. With nature at the centre, we are better placed to protect both our food and our environment.

[CTA] Find out how Biofarm's BNG solutions can work for you

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## Beyond today: strengthening long-term ecological delivery



We are delighted to welcome [Louise Martland](#) as Biofarm's Director of Ecology.

Louise brings over a decade of specialist experience in BNG, with deep expertise spanning local authority, habitat bank delivery and consultancy. She has been involved in BNG since its earliest stages and offers rare end-to-end delivery insight.

High-quality BNG depends on specialist ecological leadership. It requires navigating metrics, planning conditions, legal agreements and long-term management, and designing schemes that are realistic, compliant and capable of performing over decades.

For developers and landowners, this means reduced planning risk, clearer delivery and confidence that BNG solutions are robust, investable and built to last.

Together, we will continue to focus on delivering high-integrity off-site BNG that creates lasting value for nature, landowners, developers and communities.

[CTA] Get in touch to find out more

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